



« **Suryakumar Yadav ran along the boundary, showed remarkable balance, and completed what proved to be one of the defining catches of his career.**

India vs South Africa, 2024

India's triumph in the final of the 2024 T20 World Cup was defined by contributions at crucial moments rather than the dominance of a single player. Batting first, India was in early trouble at 34 for three inside five overs, but Virat Kohli, playing his final T20I, steadied the innings with a measured 76. He found vital support in Axar Patel, whose counterattacking 47 off 31 balls injected momentum and helped India recover to post a competitive 176 for seven. South Africa appeared in control for much of the chase at a windy Kensington Oval in Bridgetown, keeping pace with the required rate. The momentum, however, swung decisively when the equation came down to 30 runs off 30 balls. Hardik Pandya provided the first breakthrough, removing a dangerous Heinrich Klaasen (52 off 27 balls), before Jasprit Bumrah followed up by rattling Marco Jansen's stumps. The pressure intensified when Arshdeep Singh delivered a superb penultimate over, conceding just four runs to leave South Africa needing 16 from the final over. Off the first ball of the final over, Pandya bowled a full toss that David Miller launched towards long-off, where Suryakumar Yadav ran along the boundary, showed remarkable balance, and completed what proved to be one of the defining catches of his career. Pandya conceded only eight runs in the over and also removed Kagiso Rabada, sealing India's victory. The win ended an 11-year wait for an ICC title and marked India's second T20 World Cup triumph since its inaugural success in 2007.